[FINAL BOOK TITLE — TO BE DECIDED]

[SUBTITLE — TO BE DECIDED]

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The Tamil and English compositions in this book are original literary works. This book is not a translation of the *Thirukkural*, nor does it claim to reproduce Thiruvalluvar's work.

Dedication

[DEDICATION PLACEHOLDER — To be written by the author.]

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Prologue

A human life rarely unfolds as a neat argument. It arrives first as dependence, opens into wonder, and moves through learning, desire, love, work, responsibility, ambition, loss, and change. What seems permanent at one stage may look different from another. What once felt essential may later become a memory; what once seemed like an ending may reveal the beginning of another understanding.

This book follows that long human movement through nine Parts, seventy-two Chapters, and seven hundred and twenty paired compositions. The first eight Parts are organised around broad stages of life, each spanning an imagined eight-year horizon. These stages are a way of arranging reflection, not a rule for how anyone must live. Lives differ. Some experiences arrive early, some late, and some never arrive at all. The questions that shape us, however, often cross the boundaries of age.

The ninth Part steps beyond those stages. It turns towards the freedom that may emerge when wanting loosens its hold, towards stillness, the changing sense of self, the mystery of consciousness, mortality, legacy, and the unknown. It does not presume that every question has a settled answer. In matters of belief and ultimate truth, honest inquiry must leave room for uncertainty.

Tamil and English stand here as equal literary companions. Each pair begins from a shared human insight, but each language is allowed to speak in its own voice. The English composition is not simply a line-by-line translation of the Tamil, nor is the Tamil a rendering of an English original. Their relationship is closer to two perspectives meeting at the same point: connected in meaning, independent in expression.

The discipline of □□□□□ □□□□□□ gives this work an exacting formal aspiration. Its traditional Tamil rules deserve careful attention: sound, □□□, □□□□, □□□, line structure, and the ending of the verse all matter.

The English compositions face a different linguistic reality and must be judged through a separately articulated poetic method, not by pretending that Tamil prosody transfers unchanged into English. Formal claims should be earned through validation, not granted by intention alone.

These compositions are not offered as commandments for every reader. They are invitations to observe: how we become ourselves, what we ask of one another, what we cling to, what we learn to release, and how our understanding changes as the journey continues. A reader may disagree with a thought, find another meaning in it, or carry it into an experience the author never imagined. Such encounters are part of a book's life beyond its writing.

If the earlier Parts look closely at the many things that make a life, the final Part asks what remains when we see those things in perspective. The people who accompany us matter. Our choices matter. Our joys and sorrows matter. Yet love need not mean possession, and letting go need not mean indifference. Perhaps wisdom begins not by denying the journey, but by seeing both its profound value and its impermanence.

The pages that follow are an attempt to look carefully, in two languages, at the life we share and the truths we continue to seek.

Part IX — Bliss, Death and Ultimate Truth (□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□)

Chapter 65 — The Freedom Beyond Want (□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□□)

Pair 65.1 — Companions, not possessions

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Those who walk beside us shape our days;
No soul is ours to keep against the tide.

Pair 65.2 — The hunger after fulfilment

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A wish fulfilled can summon one more;
The wanting hand forgets what it now holds.

Pair 65.3 — The first freedom is seeing

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The first freedom is to name the want;
What we can see need not rule us unseen.

Pair 65.4 — Possession cannot purchase peace

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A house may fill with everything it needs;
A quiet heart is not among its things.

Pair 65.5 — Desire need not be obeyed

[illegible]
[illegible]

Let desire be seen, not instantly served;
A passing urge need not become a path.

Pair 65.6 — Release without rejection

[illegible]
[illegible]

Freedom need not turn the world to dust;
Release your grip, not your capacity to love.

Pair 65.7 — Freedom opens a choice

[illegible]
[illegible]

When want no longer drives each step,
More than one road comes into view.

Pair 65.8 — Inner peace and outer justice

[illegible]
[illegible]

An inward peace cannot make injustice right;
The free must still decide what to resist.

Pair 65.9 — Gratitude with aspiration

[illegible]
[illegible]

Be grateful for the ground beneath your feet;
Still let the seed of tomorrow rise.

Pair 65.10 — The wealth already near

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When craving loosens, ordinary things appear;
The light was here before we learned to look.

Chapter 66 — The Stillness Beyond Striving
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Pair 66.1 — A moment need not prove itself

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Not every hour must prove that it was spent;
The unmeasured moment has its own life.

Pair 66.2 — Silence is not emptiness

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Silence is not an absence of speech;
Some truths grow only when words fall still.

Pair 66.3 — Rest is not a reward

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Rest is not a prize for being worn;
The body need not break to be allowed its peace.

Pair 66.4 — Attention without pursuit

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Look without hunting for something to find;
The world grows visible when grasping fades.

Pair 66.5 — Stillness hears what haste hides

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What haste conceals, stillness lets us hear;
The quiet names the pulse beneath the noise.

Pair 66.6 — Being is more than doing

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Life is more than what the hands complete;
Being, too, belongs among our ways.

Pair 66.7 — Quiet alone is not wisdom

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Silence alone does not make us wise;
A quiet mind must still be willing to learn.

Pair 66.8 — A pause restores proportion

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A pause can set the burden in its place;
The road appears when haste steps back.

Pair 66.9 — The world moves without our hand

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The world does not wait upon our hands;
Some things unfold when we let them be.

Pair 66.10 — Wonder is not a task

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[illegible] [illegible]

Turn every wonder into a goal,
And even joy begins to keep a score.

Chapter 67 — The Dissolution of Ego (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□)

Pair 67.1 — A role is not the whole self

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The office changes; character outlives the name;
No title contains the whole of a life.

Pair 67.2 — Pride may hide behind refusal

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The ear that turns from every searching word
May guard its pride, not truth.

Pair 67.3 — The self is not the measure of all things

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A mind that makes itself the measure of all things
Cannot behold the world's full breadth.

Pair 67.4 — Humility widens the view

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Humility does not diminish sight;
It opens farther horizons.

Pair 67.5 — Attention beyond the self

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible]

Eyes fixed upon the self grow blind
To another's grief, another's radiance.

Pair 67.6 — Superiority and shame share a centre

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

The throne of superiority, the pit of shame—
Both keep the self at the centre.

Pair 67.7 — Responsibility survives the image

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible]

Let the image fall; the duty remains;
Deeds, not display, bear witness.

Pair 67.8 — Life is held in relation

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

No flame stands alone against the wind;
Life holds by ties it cannot see.

Pair 67.9 — The need to win can close the ear

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible]

THE DISSOLUTION OF EGO ([illegible] [illegible])

When victory matters more than understanding,
The listening ear closes before truth arrives.

Pair 67.10 — A quieter self makes room for the world

தன்னுருமங்கத்தரணியின்விரிவு
உள்ளத்தில்இடம்[illegible]

As the self-image recedes, the world grows vast
And finds a wider chamber in the heart.

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Chapter 68 — The Mystery of Consciousness (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□)

Pair 68.1 — Experience is known from within

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We know the inward light by which we see;
Its source remains beyond our certainty.

Pair 68.2 — A name is not an explanation

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To give a name is not to know the flame;
A word may mark the mystery, not explain.

Pair 68.3 — Theory and experience are distinct

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A theory may describe the mind's design;
The lived and living fact is not the same.

Pair 68.4 — Many traditions, many questions

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Beneath one sky, the seeking paths divide;
Each asks what another leaves aside.

Pair 68.5 — Mystery invites inquiry

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To seal a wonder with a swift conclusion
Is to extinguish the lamp of inquiry.

Pair 68.6 — Wisdom knows the edge of knowledge

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Wisdom knows where knowledge reaches its shore;
Beyond that line, it claims no more.

Pair 68.7 — Inner experience and outward proof

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What stirs within resists the public word;
Evidence and experience are differently heard.

Pair 68.8 — Wonder and inquiry belong together

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Wonder and inquiry need not part;
They are the twin eyes of the searching heart.

Pair 68.9 — Metaphor is not proof

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A metaphor may lead us to the door;
It is not proof of what lies there.

Pair 68.10 — Leave the deepest question open

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[illegible]

Before the deepest question, bow the mind;
Let honest seeking leave the door unclosed.

Chapter 69 — The Shadow of Death (□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□)

Pair 69.1 — The day is precious because it passes

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Because the day must pass, its light is dear;
The fleeting hour is precious while it is here.

Pair 69.2 — An ending cannot unmake a life

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The end cannot unmake the life once lived;
The bloom remains, though petals fall.

Pair 69.3 — A farewell is shaped by love

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Love keeps a light beside the final door;
Tears speak the words the lips can say no more.

Pair 69.4 — Grief bears witness to love

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Grief is not love’s failure to let go;
It is the depth from which the love once grew.

Pair 69.5 — Say what matters while there is time

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

Speak the tender truth while breath is near;
No promise holds the shape of another year.

Pair 69.6 — The body returns to the earth

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

The body returns to the patient earth;
Dust rejoins the ground that gave it birth.

Pair 69.7 — What we give continues in others

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

The love we give does not depart with us;
It flowers in lives we may never see.

Pair 69.8 — Let the final hour be met with dignity

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

A gentle leave-taking is no small grace;
Love makes a shelter of the final place.

Pair 69.9 — The beyond remains unknown

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

What waits beyond, no living voice can say;
The unknown need not darken this clear day.

Pair 69.10 — Let life be the final testament

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Let goodness live in those who journey on;
Then even farewell leaves a lamp aglow.

Chapter 70 — The Persistence of Legacy (□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□)

Pair 70.1 — Goodness outlives the name

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A name may fade; the good we leave takes root
In lives made kinder by the seeds we sow.

Pair 70.2 — Small kindness can travel far

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A little kindness travels farther than we know;
Its quiet harvest ripens in another heart.

Pair 70.3 — Memory is not possession

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Those who remember us are not our own;
Their lives carry love along a road of theirs.

Pair 70.4 — Deeds speak beyond monuments

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More lasting than a name cut into stone
Is the shelter one good deed provides.

Pair 70.5 — Stories change in the telling

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[illegible]

The years may alter every tale retold;
The kindness given still has touched the world.

Pair 70.6 — Influence may outlive recognition

[illegible]
[illegible]

The hand may pass from every memory;
The light it kindled still can guide a life.

Pair 70.7 — What we pass on is changed by others

[illegible]
[illegible]

What we bequeath is changed by those who receive;
A living gift grows in another shape.

Pair 70.8 — The hunger to be remembered can mislead

[illegible]
[illegible]

Who lives to be remembered may forget
The living hearts that ask for care today.

Pair 70.9 — The truest inheritance is capacity

[illegible]
[illegible]

Give others courage, give them room to grow;
Your life continues in the strength they find.

Pair 70.10 — Let what remains be a blessing

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible]

If goodness remains because we once were here,
Our passing leaves the world a gentler place.

Chapter 71 — The Threshold of the Unknown (□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□)

Pair 71.1 — The unknown is not an enemy

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Do not call every unlit road a threat;
Some dawns begin beyond the sight of home.

Pair 71.2 — An unanswered question still has worth

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A question need not end to have its worth;
It can keep the mind awake and kind.

Pair 71.3 — Fear rushes to certainty

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Fear builds a wall from whatever words it finds;
A wall is not an answer to the dark.

Pair 71.4 — Imagination is a lantern, not proof

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Imagination can lend the dark a shape;
It cannot swear that shape is true.

Pair 71.5 — Uncertainty can be shared

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

We need not hide the limits of our sight;
Shared doubt can make a gentler shelter.

Pair 71.6 — The horizon may move

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

The edge of what we know may move with time;
Today's far shore may be tomorrow's ground.

Pair 71.7 — Patience honours incomplete evidence

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible]

When evidence is still a scattered light,
Let patience keep the verdict from its throne.

Pair 71.8 — Mystery must not be exploited

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

Do not sell a certainty the dark cannot give;
A searching heart deserves an honest guide.

Pair 71.9 — Weigh explanations by their grounds

[illegible] [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]
[illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

A beautiful account may still be false;
Ask what can bear the weight of what it claims.

Pair 71.10 — Leave the door open

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Leave one small door unsealed against the night;
Humility asks, but does not promise dawn.

Chapter 72 — The Ultimate Truth (□□□□□□□□□□)

Pair 72.1 — Wanting does not make a thing true

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The heart may long for truth to take its side;
The truth remains beyond the wish it meets.

Pair 72.2 — Words point beyond themselves

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Words point towards the light they cannot hold;
The finger is not the flame it shows.

Pair 72.3 — Comfort is not proof

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A belief may soothe the wound within the heart;
Its comfort alone cannot make it true.

Pair 72.4 — Different truths require different ways of knowing

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The kind of question shapes the proof it needs;
No single measure weighs the whole of life.

Pair 72.5 — Certainty is not truth

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A voice made certain does not make truth so;
Doubt, honestly held, can clear the sight.

Pair 72.6 — The seeker must examine the self

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Who seeks the truth must question the seeker too;
Desire can bend the mirror of the mind.

Pair 72.7 — No single image contains the whole

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No image can contain the whole of what is;
The sky exceeds the window made for it.

Pair 72.8 — Conviction can remain humble

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A deep conviction need not close the ear;
Belief can stand without making others small.

Pair 72.9 — Meaning cannot be possessed

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Meaning is not a prize the hand can own;
We draw near by how we live and see.

Pair 72.10 — Live truthfully at the edge of knowing

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[illegible] [illegible]

We may not own the truth we seek;
We may still live by what we know is true.

Epilogue

[EPILOGUE PLACEHOLDER — To be written after all 720 paired compositions have been completed and reviewed. The epilogue should bring the book's journey together without merely summarising the Chapters or claiming certainty where the work has preserved an open question.]

About the Author

V.T.R. Ravi Kumar is a technologist and writer whose professional life has spanned software engineering, architecture, and emerging technologies. This book brings a different discipline to his work: the pursuit of human insight through the literary possibilities of Tamil and English.

[AUTHOR BIO PLACEHOLDER — Review and finalise the biography, preferred public links, and any author photograph or acknowledgements before publication.]